Night Shift

On-call agents that never solve the same incident twice, even when the other shift solved it.

ContextCon: Remember Everything · Theme 02 Agentic support: Never Solve It Twice

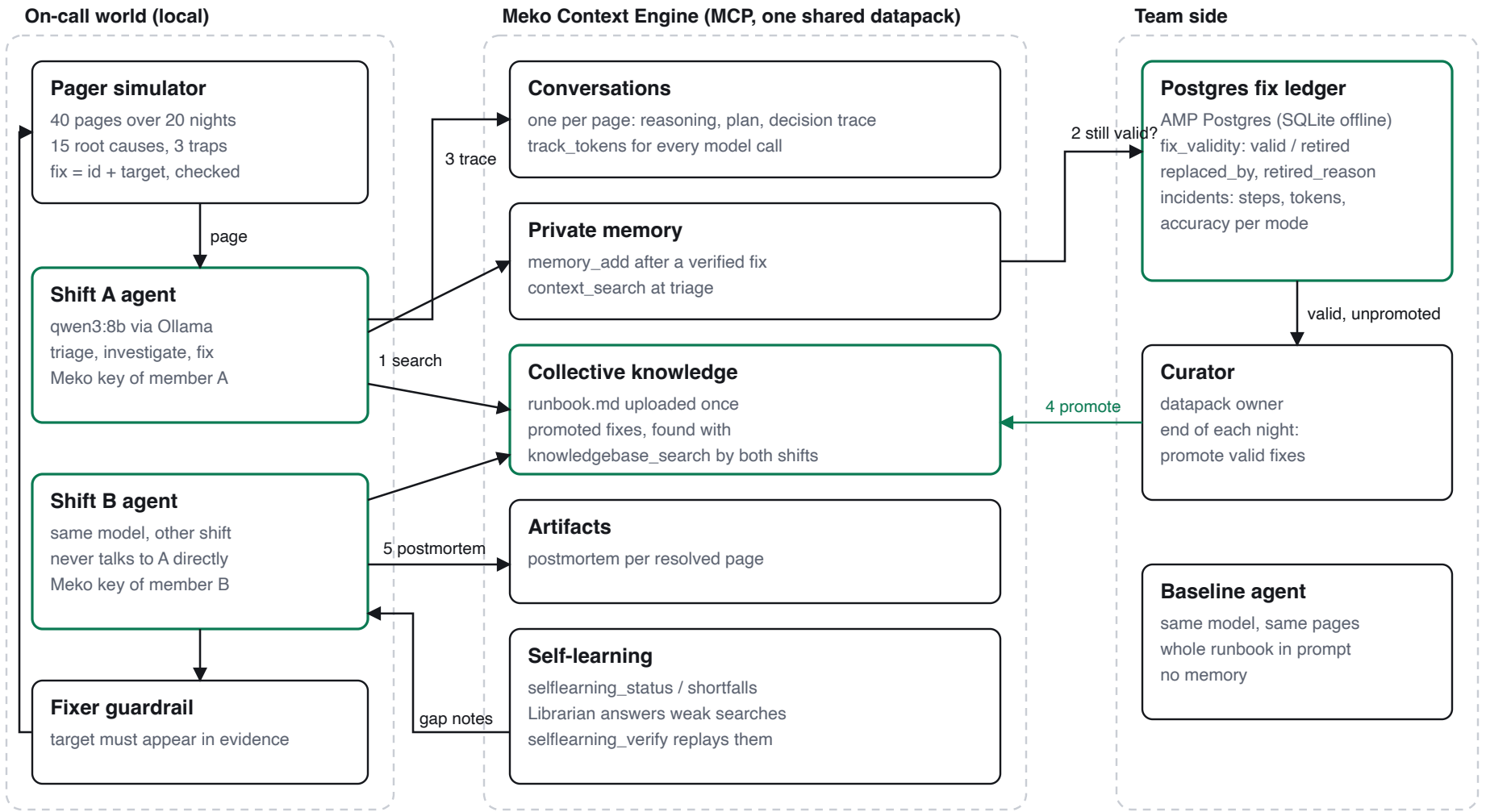
github.com/kangraemin/nightshift-meko

The same page gets solved twice

- Internal on-call teams split the night into shifts.
- The engineer who fixed the 2 a.m. page writes it down in their own notes, if at all.
- The next shift gets the same page and starts from the wiki again.
- The wiki is half right: it describes last year's causes, not this week's.
- Worse, a remembered fix can stop working. Applying it again wastes the first ten minutes of an outage.

Night Shift turns each verified fix into team memory, and keeps a ledger of which remembered fixes still work.

How it works


On-call world (local)
Pager simulator
40 pages over 20 nights
15 root causes, 3 traps
fix = id + target, checked
page
Shift A agent
qwen3:8b via Ollama
triage, investigate, fix
Meko key of member A
Shift B agent
same model, other shift
never talks to A directly
Meko key of member B
Fixer guardrail
target must appear in evidence
Meko Context Engine (MCP, one shared datapack)
Conversations
one per page: reasoning, plan, decision trace
track_tokens for every model call
Private memory
memory_add after a verified fix
context_search at triage
Collective knowledge
runbook.md uploaded once
promoted fixes, found with
knowledgebase_search by both shifts
Artifacts
postmortem per resolved page
Self-learning
selflearning_status / shortfalls
Librarian answers weak searches
selflearning_verify replays them
3 trace
1 search
5 postmortem
gap notes
Team side
Postgres fix ledger
AMP Postgres (SQLite offline)
fix_validity: valid / retired
replaced_by, retired_reason
incidents: steps, tokens,
accuracy per mode
2 still valid?
valid, unpromoted
Curator
datapack owner
end of each night:
promote valid fixes
4 promote
Baseline agent
same model, same pages
whole runbook in prompt
no memory

One page, end to end

- **Triage.** The shift searches its own memory and the team's collective knowledge in Meko.
- **Check.** Every hit is joined with the Postgres fix ledger: valid, retired, or unverified.
- **Investigate.** The agent runs diagnostics. The Fixer only applies a fix to a target seen in evidence or memory.
- **Remember.** A verified fix becomes a private memory, a postmortem artifact and a ledger row.
- **Learn from people.** When the agent gives up, the on-call human's fix is stored the same way, marked as written by a person.
- **Share.** At the end of the night the datapack owner promotes every fix the ledger still marks valid. The other shift finds them next time.
- **Forget on purpose.** When a remembered fix fails, the ledger retires it and the Fixer refuses it from then on.

Postgres keeps memory honest

Promoted memories cannot be edited or deleted over MCP. Retrieval alone cannot tell a good memory from a stale one. So the ledger decides.

```
INC-24 · checkout is throwing 502s, p99 latency 2s
apply_fix F01 pgb-checkout-rw on pgbouncer: REFUSED by Fixer: the fix ledger retired F01 pgb-checkout-rw for this alert (INC-20: F01 applied, symptoms per…
get_pool_stats on pgbouncer: pgbouncer: pool cl_waiting=0 cl_active=3 maxwait=0s
get_config on checkout-api: checkout-api: config unchanged in 15 days
get_queue on notify-queue: notify-queue: no queues owned or depth=0
apply_fix F09 new_pricing_engine on checkout-api: disable_flag <flag name> new_pricing_engine applied on checkout-api: symptoms persist (checkout is throwing 50…
get_metrics on checkout-api: checkout-api: symptom confirmed (checkout is throwing 502s, p99 latency 2s); own cpu/mem normal; errors are on…
get_dependencies on checkout-api: checkout-api upstreams: pgbouncer healthy, postgres DEGRADED (errors/timeouts from here), payments healthy, in…
```

Same model, same 40 pages, 3 live runs

qwen3:8b on a laptop. Left: whole runbook in the prompt. Right: Night Shift. Graded by a deterministic simulator.

	Pages	Runbook in prompt	Night Shift	Steps	Tokens per page
First seen	12	56%	**61%**	8.4 → 7.2	11,173 → 8,948
Repeat	25	56%	**92%**	8.7 → 2.8	11,662 → 3,972
Trap	3	33%	33%	9.7 → 9.4	13,358 → 13,945
All	40	54%	**78%**	8.7 → 4.6	11,642 → 6,213

Mean of 3 live runs (each shuffles which shift gets which page). On repeat pages Night Shift resolved 92% (96% / 92% / 88%) against 56%, with 66% fewer tokens. First-seen pages gain too, from searching the runbook instead of pasting it (see the next slide).

Where the gain comes from

Same Night Shift agent, three switches: nothing remembered, private memory only, shared through Meko.

Night Shift lane	First seen	Repeats	Steps per repeat
Runbook search only, no memory	64%	64%	7.8
Private memory only	67%	71%	6.0
Shared through Meko	61%	**91%**	3.3

Offline, same pages, mean of 3 seeds. Retrieval alone explains the first-seen gain; remembering adds 7 points on repeats, sharing across shifts 20 more (13 of the 25 repeats first happened on the other shift).

Does the ledger matter?

Same offline runs with the Postgres ledger switched off: memories are still learned and shared, but every remembered fix looks valid forever.

Night Shift lane	Repeats	Traps	Failed fixes applied	Fixes refused
Memory without the ledger	92%	33%	20.3 per run	21.0 per run
Memory checked against the ledger	91%	33%	**12.3 per run**	29.7 per run

Offline, mean of 3 seeds. A failed fix is a real change to production (rollback, restart, drain, config edit) that did not clear the page. Resolution barely moves; wrong changes to production drop 39%.

People stay in the loop

- **Review before sharing.** A learned fix stays with its shift until a person approves it (`nightshift.review approve`). A rejected fix is retired, so the Fixer refuses it.
- **Fixes made by hand.** When the agent gives up, the engineer's fix goes into Meko as that shift's memory, marked as written by a person. Over the 3 live runs: 26 human notes, and later pages that started from one were resolved 28 times out of 32.
- **Real alerts.** An Alertmanager webhook runs the same triage on a live alert: what the team already fixed, who fixed it on which page, and which old fix the ledger says not to re-apply. It suggests; it never acts.

Every Meko layer has a job

Conversations + messages	decision trace for every page, reasoning and plan
Token tracking	local-model tokens next to each trace
Private memory	memory_add after a verified fix, context_search at triage
Collective knowledge	runbook upload, memory_promote by the curator, knowledgebase_search
Artifacts	postmortem markdown per resolved page
Self-learning	shortfalls answered by a librarian, then replayed with selflearning_verify
Datapack sharing	shift B is a second Meko member with Contributor access
Postgres in the context	fix_validity ledger joined with every memory hit

Limits and next steps

- The incidents are simulated so that grading is exact. Real pages are messier.
- One 8B local model, no paid API. A larger model solves more first-seen pages in both modes.
- Traps stay hard: 33% of trap pages resolved, same as the runbook lane (33%). The ledger stops the old fix; finding the new cause is still up to the model.
- Next: wire the agent's diagnostics to real tools behind the webhook, and let the ledger expire fixes after a deploy.

Code, replay and results: github.com/kangraemin/nightshift-meko